

room table for all to use. I also made my teenage daughter pay for the oil change in the car we share.

It got to the point where I'd open the refrigerator and yell, "You bought too much broccoli," or "We already have white rice," or "Why have three new lettuces when one is rotten in the crisper?" I counted the spices and noticed there were three oreganos and complained: "Every time there's a trip to the grocery store, somebody buys another oregano."

Worrying about oregano duplication is a sure sign of trouble with the investments. Other signs are: a sudden interest in energy conservation, questioning the water bill or the monthly garbage service, complaining about greedy charities, and making the children buy their own stamps—all of which can be summarized in Useful Tip Number 22:

The larger the sum you've lost, the smaller the sums you'll worry about

I hoped my family would take my frugal campaigns seriously, but they didn't. They knew all along that my moral stand on broccoli had something to do with what had happened in Chicago. Unbeknownst to me, they'd figured out months earlier that my moods went up and down with the stock market. In fact, they could almost predict the Dow Jones by how many household purchases I encouraged or condemned.

Anyway, I was back home with my Loews gone wrong, and feeling worse and worse. Suddenly, I got an urge to get out of the market altogether. On July 29, I called Ms. Garrett and ordered her to sell everything, the Gillette, the Angstrom, and whatever was left of my options, and I didn't care about the price.

A day later, I found out I'd gotten \$2,146.91 for the remaining 2,500 shares of Angstrom (a loss of \$2,824.66 from the original cost); \$4,535.96 for the Gillette (a profit of \$308.72); and I'd sold the 10 Loews calls for \$895.40 (a loss of \$710.07). Altogether, it was a terrible day. Of the entire \$14,700 I'd put into the markets since the previous December, I was left with about half, or \$7,577.

Yet this costly closeout made me strangely happy! I felt even